

Florbot v1.0: Complete Installation & Setup Guide

Welcome to Florbot! This comprehensive guide will walk you through the entire process of setting up and running Florbot v1.0 on your machine from scratch.

Note: For a printable, offline version of these instructions with additional visual references, please see the accompanying **Florbot_Installation_Guide.pdf**.

Phase 1: Core Prerequisites

Before downloading Florbot, you need to prepare your computer by installing the necessary software environment.

1. Install Python (The Engine)

Florbot requires Python 3.12 or newer to run.

1. Navigate to the official Python website: <https://www.python.org/downloads/>
2. Download the latest release for your operating system (Windows/macOS).
3. **CRITICAL STEP:** When you launch the installer, look at the bottom of the first window and check the box that says "**Add Python to PATH**" or "**Add python.exe to PATH**". If you skip this, Florbot will not run.
4. Click **Install Now** and wait for the process to complete.
5. *Verify Installation:* Open your computer's Command Prompt or Terminal and type `python --version`. Press Enter. It should respond with Python 3.12.x.

2. Install Visual Studio Code (The Editor)

We recommend Visual Studio Code (VS Code) to view and manage Florbot's files.

1. Download VS Code from <https://code.visualstudio.com/>.
2. Run the installer and accept all the default settings.
3. *(Optional but Recommended):* Once VS Code is open, click the "Extensions" icon on the left sidebar (four blocks) and search for "Python". Install the official Python extension provided by Microsoft for the best experience.

Phase 2: Setting Up Florbot

3. Extract and Open the Project

1. Locate your downloaded Florbot ZIP file.
2. Right-click the ZIP file and select **Extract All...** to unpack the files into a standard folder.
3. Open VS Code. Go to the top menu and select **File > Open Folder...**
4. Navigate to your newly extracted Florbot folder and select it.

4. Prepare the Command Terminal

1. Inside VS Code, look at the top menu bar and select **Terminal > New Terminal**.
2. Alternatively, use the keyboard shortcut: Ctrl + ~ (the tilde key, usually below Escape).
3. A command-line panel will open at the bottom of your screen, pointing directly to your Florbot folder.

5. Install Dependencies

Florbot relies on external libraries to function. You need to install these using Python's package manager (pip).

1. In the VS Code Terminal, type the following command exactly as written:
`pip install -r requirements.txt`
2. Press **Enter**. You will see a lot of text scrolling by as Python downloads and installs the necessary components. Wait until it completely finishes and returns you to a blinking cursor.

Phase 3: Running Florbot

6. Launch the Application

You are now ready to start Florbot!

1. In your VS Code terminal, run the following command:
`python Florbot1.0.py`
2. Press **Enter**. Florbot should now initialize and begin running.

Phase 4: Optional Configuration

How to Auto-Start Florbot with Windows

If you want Florbot to automatically launch in the background every time you turn on your computer:

1. Press the **Windows Key + R** on your keyboard to open the "Run" dialog box.
2. Type exactly `shell:startup` and press **Enter**. A folder will open.
3. Go back to your extracted Florbot folder. Right-click on Florbot1.0.py (or a batch file if you made one to run it) and select **Create Shortcut**.
4. Drag and drop that newly created shortcut into the Startup folder you opened in step 2.

Troubleshooting & FAQ

- **Error: "Python is not recognized as an internal or external command"**
 - *Fix:* You likely forgot to check "Add Python to PATH" during installation. Re-run the Python installer, choose "Modify", and ensure the PATH checkbox is ticked.

- **Error: "Could not open requirements file: [Errno 2] No such file or directory: 'requirements.txt'"**
 - *Fix:* Your terminal is in the wrong folder. Make sure you used **File > Open Folder** in VS Code to open the specific folder that *contains* requirements.txt and Florbot1.0.py, not the folder above it.